

A Choice That Has a Cost: The First Promise

有代价的选择：第一次承诺

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The first promise was made at the graduation ceremony, in the **cold** of a **western** winter: each **graduate** would publish one **chapter** of the group's **history**. "The **goal** is not the **size** of the report," the **director** said at the **meeting**, "it is the **duty** to hand over the **primary** record."

The **average** reader of the **index** would never see the **distribution** of the **evidence**, and that was the point. "A **dead** archive is a **kind** of **lie**," Maya said. "A **present-tense** account is a **kind** of **evidence**." The **spirit** of the **assignment** was to write down the **origin** of every number, including the ones with a **fault**.

The **moment** of **conversion** came with a photograph. "This **image** is **identical** to the one in the **party's** leaflet," Lin said. "We have tied our **history** to a **political** leaflet, and we did not notice." The **stake** was not money but the **taste** of the whole project.

The **rough** draft of the fifth **chapter** had a **tie** to an **antique** map and a **reserve** of unprocessed field notes. "A **trick** of presentation will not save a weak **index**," the **director** said. "A **sacrifice** is required, and it is the **sacrifice** of the pretty sentence."

The **confusion** in the room was about ownership. "**Only ten** of us wrote it, and **even** the **town** has a claim," the editor said. "We cannot **cling** to a private **sphere** and call it public scholarship." The **reward** for publishing was, in the end, the release itself.

A **faint frost** on the window, a **stroke** of the pen, and the **preview** of the last page: the promise was convert into a series of small assignments, and the **convertible** one was the **only** one the group could honestly sign. The **ten** of us met **then**, and the **section** on the **party** was the hardest. A **type** of **town**, a **certain world**, a **town** that would not **die**: the **evidence** was **political even** when we said that it was not. We had to **show** the **break** in the record and let the reader see it, and **only** the **town** could decide what to publish. The **present** page would **seem** to **choke** on its own **inclination**.

中文翻译

第一个承诺是在毕业典礼上做出的，在一个西方冬天的寒冷里：每位毕业生将公开这个小组历史中的一章。“目标不是报告的规模，”主管在会上说，“而是移交第一手记录的责任。”

索引的普通读者永远不会看到证据的分布，而重点正在这里。“一座死的档案是一种谎言，”曼雅说，“一份现在时态的记述是一种证据。”这项任务的精神是写下每一个数字的来源，包括那些有毛病的。

转变的时刻随着一张照片到来。“这张影像与那份党传单上的一模一样，”林伟说，“我们把我们的历史系在了一份政治传单上，而我们没有注意到。”赌注不是钱，而是整个项目的情调。

第五章的粗略草稿与一张古董地图和一批未整理的野外笔记有关。“呈现上的一个诀窍救不了一个虚弱的索引，”主管说，“需要一种牺牲，而它就是牺牲那句漂亮的句子。”

屋里的混乱是关于归属的。“只有我们十个人写了它，而连镇上也有份，”编辑说，“我们不能紧抓着一个私人领域，然后称之为公共学术。”公开的报酬，说到底，就是那次公开本身。

窗上一层淡淡的霜、笔的一划，以及最后一页的预览：这个承诺被转换成一连串小任务，而可转换的那一个，是小组唯一能诚实地签下的一个。我们十个人那时聚在一起，而关于那个党的那一节最难写。一种城镇、一个特定的世界、一个不会死去的城镇：即使我们说它不是政治的，这些证据也是政治的。我们必须展示记录中的断裂，并让读者看见它，而只有那个镇能决定公布什么。眼前这一页似乎会被自己的倾向噎住。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
kind kaɪnd POS: n	n. 种类, 性质, 方式; a. 亲切的, 仁慈的, 和蔼的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a category of things distinguished by some common characteristic or quality; a. having or showing a tender...
history ˈhɪstəri POS: n	n. 历史, 过去, 经历, 发展过程, 历史学, 过去的事, 历史记录; [计] 历史记录 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the aggregate of past events; n. a record or narrative description of past events; n. the discipline that re...
moment ˈməʊmənt POS: n	n. 片刻, 瞬间, 重要, 阶段, 力矩; [医] 片刻, 瞬间, 时机, 因素, 矩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particular point in time; n. an indefinitely short time; n. a turning force produced by an object acting a...
die daɪ POS: vi	vi. 死亡, 消逝, 平息, 熄灭, 漠然, 渴望; vt. 死; n. 骰子, 冲模 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small cube with 1 to 6 spots on the six faces; used in gambling to generate random numbers; n. a device u...
break breɪk POS: n	n. 休息, 中断, 破裂处, 绝交, 破晓, 突变; vt. 打破, 弄破, 弄坏, 破坏, 违反, 打断, 削弱, 放弃; vi. 破碎, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unexpected piece of good luck; n. the occurrence of breaking; n. an abrupt change in the tone or register...
image ˈɪmɪdʒ POS: n	n. 影像, 肖像, 想象, 图像, 形象, 翻版; vt. 作...的像, 反映, 想象, 象征; n. 图像; [计] 图象 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an iconic mental representation; n. (mathematics) the set of values of the dependent variable for which a f...
chapter ˈtʃæptə POS: n	n. 章, 篇, 重要章节; [计] 章; 段 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a subdivision of a written work; usually numbered and titled; n. any distinct period in history or in a per...
present ˈpreznt POS: n	n. 现在, 礼品, 瞄准; a. 现在的, 出席的; vt. 介绍, 引见, 赠送, 提出, 呈现, 上演; vi. 举枪瞄准 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the period of time that is happening now; any continuous stretch of time including the moment of speech; n. ...
goal ɡəʊl POS: n	n. 目标, 终点, 得分, 球门, 守门员; vi. 攻门, 射门得分 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of affairs that a plan is intended to achieve and that (when achieved) terminates behavior inten...
size saɪz POS: n	n. 大小, 尺寸, 规模, 尺码, 能力, 浆料; vt. 上浆, 依大小排列; vi. 可比拟; a. 一定大小的, 一定尺寸的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the physical magnitude of something (how big it is); n. the property resulting from being one of a series o...
dead ded POS: a	a. 死的, 不活泼的, 麻木的, 熄灭的; n. 死者; adv. 完全地, 直接地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people who are no longer living; n. a time when coldness (or some other quality associated with death) is i...
duty ˈdju:ti POS: n	n. 责任, 关税, 职务, 尊敬; [化] 职责 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the social force that binds you to the courses of action demanded by that force; every opportunity, an obl...
cold kəʊld POS: n	n. 感冒, 寒冷; a. 寒冷的, 冷淡的, 冷静的; adv. 完全地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mild viral infection involving the nose and respiratory passages (but not the lungs); n. the sensation pr...
western ˈwestən POS: n	n. 西方人, 西部片, 西部小说; a. 向西方的, 来自西方的, 西方的, 西洋的, 西部的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a film about life in the western United States during the period of exploration and development; n. a sandw...
primary ˈpraɪməri POS: n	n. 最主要者, 原色; a. 主要的, 初期的, 根本的, 原始的, 首要的, 基本的; [计] 初等量; 主要的; 一次的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a preliminary election where delegates or nominees are chosen; n. one of the main flight feathers projectin...
spirit ˈspɪrɪt POS: n	n. 精神, 心灵, 灵魂, 态度, 志气, 人格, 情绪, 心情, 烈酒; vt. 诱拐, 鼓励, 鼓舞 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the vital principle or animating force within living things; n. the general atmosphere of a place or situat...
average ˈævərɪdʒ POS: n	n. 平均, 平均数, 一般水平, 海损; a. 平均的, 中等的, 平常的; vt. 算出...平均数, 平均做, 均分, 使平衡; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a statistic describing the location of a distribution; n. (sports) the ratio of successful performances to...
distribution ˌdɪstrɪˈbju:ʃən POS: n	n. 分配; [计] 分布 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (statistics) an arrangement of values of a variable showing their observed or theoretical frequency of occ...
tie taɪ POS: n	n. 带子, 线, 鞋带, 领带, 领结, 关系, 束缚, 平局, 不分胜负; vt. 系, 打结, 扎, 约束, 与...成平局; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. equality of score in a contest; n. a horizontal beam used to prevent two other structural members from spre...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
index 'indeks POS: n	n. 索引, 指针, 指数, 指标; vt. 编入索引中, 指出; vi. 做索引; [计] 下标; 附标; 变址; 索引; 编索引 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a numerical scale used to compare variables with one another or with some reference number; n. a number or...
origin 'ɒrɪdʒɪn POS: n	n. 起源, 起因, 出身, 开端; [计] 原点; 起始地址; 信件来源的相关数据 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. properties attributable to your ancestry; n. an event that is a beginning; a first part or stage of subsequ...
taste teɪst POS: n	n. 味道, 品味, 味觉, 感受, 体验, 爱好, 审美, 少量; vt. 尝, 察觉...的味道, 体会; vi. 品尝, 察觉味道, 有... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sensation that results when taste buds in the tongue and throat convey information about the chemical...
fault fɔ:lt POS: n	n. 过错, 故障, 毛病; vt. 挑剔; vi. 产生断层, 弄错; [计] 故障 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (geology) a crack in the earth's crust resulting from the displacement of one side with respect to the oth...
graduate 'grædʒueɪt POS: n	n. 毕业生, 量杯; a. 已得学位的, 研究生的, 毕业的; vi. 毕业, 得学位, 逐渐变为; vt. 准予...毕业, 授予...学位... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a measuring instrument for measuring fluid volume; a glass container (cup or cylinder or flask) whose side...
rough rʌf POS: n	n. 粗糙的东西, 毛坯, 未加工品, 梗概, 草图, 暴徒, 艰难; a. 粗糙的, 粗暴的, 蓬乱的, 草率的, 大致的, 简陋的, 暴... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the part of a golf course bordering the fairway where the grass is not cut short; a. having or caused by an...
reserve rɪ'zə:v POS: n	n. 储备品, 贮量, 后备军, 自然保护区, 保留, 拘谨, 节制, 储备金; vt. 保留, 保存, 预订, 延期, 推迟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something kept back or saved for future use or a special purpose; n. (medicine) potential capacity to respo...
stake steɪk POS: n	n. 桩, 炮烙刑, 木柱, 赌注, 奖金; vt. 打桩, 用桩撑, 下赌注, 资助; vi. 打赌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. instrument of execution consisting of a vertical post that a victim is tied to for burning; n. the money ri...
confusion kən'fju:ʒən POS: n	n. 混乱, 混淆, 无秩序; [计] 含混 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. disorder resulting from a failure to behave predictably; n. a mental state characterized by a lack of clear...
reward rɪ'wɔ:d POS: n	n. 报酬, 酬谢, 赏金; vt. 奖赏, 酬谢, 给...应有报应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. payment made in return for a service rendered; n. an act performed to strengthen approved behavior; n. the o...
trick trɪk POS: n	n. 诡计, 欺诈, 谋略, 恶作剧, 习惯, 诀窍; vt. 愚弄, 欺骗, 装饰; vi. 哄骗, 戏弄; a. 有诀窍的, 特技的, 欺诈... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a cunning or deceitful action or device; n. a period of work or duty; n. an attempt to get you to do somethi...
stroke strəʊk POS: n	n. 笔划, 打, 中风, 抚, 摩, 冲程; vt. 划尾桨, 抚, 摩, 划去; [计] 笔划 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (sports) the act of swinging or striking at a ball with a club or racket or bat or cue or hand; n. a sudden...
assignment ə'saɪnmənt POS: n	n. 分配, 功课, 任务, 转让, 归因, 陈述; [计] 赋值 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a duty that you are assigned to perform (especially in the armed forces); n. the instrument by which a clai...
conversion kən'veɪʃən POS: n	n. 转变, 转换, 改变宗教信仰, 换位法; [计] 转换 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an event that results in a transformation; n. a change in the units or form of an expression: "conversion f...
identical aɪ'dentɪkəl POS: a	a. 同一的, 恒等的, 完全相同的; [医] 同一的, 同等的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. exactly alike; incapable of being perceived as different; s. being the exact same one; not any other; a. (o...
faint feɪnt POS: n	n. 昏厥, 昏倒; a. 模糊的, 微弱的, 无力的; vi. 昏倒, 变得微弱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a spontaneous loss of consciousness caused by insufficient blood to the brain; v. pass out from weakness, p...
sphere sfɪə POS: n	n. 球, 球面, 球体, 天体, 地球仪, 范围; vt. 包围, 使成球体, 放入球内 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particular environment or walk of life; n. any spherically shaped artifact; n. the geographical area in wh...
cling klɪŋ POS: vi	vi. 粘紧, 附着, 紧贴, 坚持 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. fruit (especially peach) whose flesh adheres strongly to the pit; v. come or be in close contact with; stic...
sacrifice 'sækrɪfaɪs POS: n	n. 牺牲, 供奉, 祭品; vt. 牺牲, 祭祀, 贱卖; vi. 献祭 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. personnel that are sacrificed (e.g., surrendered or lost in order to gain an objective); n. a loss entailed...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
choke tʃəuk POS: vt	vt. 窒息, 阻塞, 噎, 抑制; vi. 窒息, 阻塞, 噎; n. 窒息, 噎, 阻气门 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a coil of low resistance and high inductance used in electrical circuits to pass direct current and attenuate...
antique æn'ti:k POS: n	n. 古董, 古物; a. 古老的, 古风的, 旧式的, 过时的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any piece of furniture or decorative object or the like produced in a former period and valuable because of...
inclination ˌɪnklɪ'neɪʃən POS: n	n. 倾向, 趋向, 倾斜度, 点头; [化] 倾角 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an attitude of mind especially one that favors one alternative over others; n. (astronomy) the angle between...
frost frost POS: n	n. 霜, 冰冻, 冷漠; vt. 覆着霜, 冻结, 结霜; vi. 受冻, 起霜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. ice crystals forming a white deposit (especially on objects outside); n. the formation of frost or ice on a...
preview 'pri:vju: POS: n	n. 事先查看, 预览; vt. 事先查看, 预演; [计] 预览 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an advertisement consisting of short scenes from a motion picture that will appear in the near future; n. a...
convertible kən've:təbl POS: a	a. 可改变的, 可交换的; n. 有活动篷的汽车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a car that has top that can be folded or removed; n. a corporate security (usually bonds or preferred stock)...